LVNA
EST 1958

VILLAGER

Volume 65 Edition 5 May 2022 Representing 1,614 Households

What's In This Issue

Lakewood Park Tree Walk	1
Recap of the April General Meeting	3
Special Memorial Day Photo Scavenger Hunt	4
Reminders	5

- Lakewood Park Tree Walk -



Tree #1 (London Plane)

Sunnyvale Urban Forest Advocates (SUFA) is a local group dedicated to all things trees. Their mission is to educate the public and City officials about urban forests and their benefits, advocate to preserve and expand the urban forest,, and participate in tree maintenance and planting. As part of their mission, they have curated several local tree walks - short walks with accompanying tree guides to teach the public more about our local trees. Guided walks are scheduled periodically, but their website includes information for residents to do their own, self-guided walks as well. The tree walk maps can be found here

(http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-walk-maps/), and the tree guides here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-guide/).

On April 9, SUFA hosted one of these tree walks at Lakewood Park. It was nearly two hours long, and the guides were full of information and stories. For those who were unable to join - or are unable to do the self-guided tree walks, we wanted to highlight some of our local trees. We will begin with the first tree on the walk.

Begin at the north side of the park building and look to the east, towards the playground and Silverlake Dr. See those tall, deciduous* trees lining both sides of the walkway, planted in straight lines? Those are our Tree #1 - the London Plane tree, Latin name *Platanus x acerifolia*. Due to its tolerance for pollution, the London Plane tree is a particularly common urban roadside tree and was very popular in Victorian London. Today, London Plane trees account for over 10% of the trees in New York City, which now restricts when the trees can be planted. London Plane have distinct mottled trunks. Their large leaves are similar to maple trees, although sycamore leaves only have three main veins while maples have five or seven main veins. Mature trees, which can reach a height of 70-100 feet, have wonderful displays of foliage. London Plane trees are a hybrid of two other trees - the Western Sycamore (*Platanus occidentalis*) and the Oriental Sycamore (*Platanus orientalis*). The London Plane and the Western Sycamore (also called the California Sycamore) can be distinguished mostly by their location - London Planes are planted almost exclusively in urban areas, while Western Sycamores grow naturally only in wet areas.

Want to learn more? Check out these links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Platanus_%C3%97_acerifolia
- https://www.canadiantreetours.org/species-pages/London_plane-tree.html
- https://calscape.org/Platanus-racemosa-(Western-Sycamore)

* A quick refresher: Deciduous trees lose their leaves in winter. Conifer, or evergreen, trees keep their needles year-round.

Courtesy to Sunnyvale Forest Advocates (SUFA) for allowing us to reproduce their website content in our Village. For more information, see their website at http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/

- Recap of the April General Meeting -

The Villager typically does not include a summary from the prior month's general meeting, since those meetings are recorded. However, since the April general meeting was not recorded, here is a quick summary of the conversation with our guest speaker, Officer Chen from Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety.

On unhoused residents:

- Sunnyvale only has one full-time shelter to support our unhoused residents. Due to covid, bed capacity has been reduced and current residents are allowed to stay as long as needed. This severely limits the housing options available for our unhoused community.
- The City Council recently approved spending $500,000 to support homeless resources
- The 2018 decision by the US Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit in the court case "Martin vs Boise" declared that cities cannot enforce anti-camping ordinances unless the city has enough shelter beds to provide a bed to everyone in its homeless population. California is under the jurisdiction of the Ninth Circuit court, which means this ruling applies to our state. Therefore, since Sunnyvale does not have enough such beds, the City cannot force unhoused residents out of their camps.
- As part of the renovation of the Fair Oaks Park, the City did provide funding for a six-month motel program for the 31 individuals who lived in the encampment at that pak. More details about this can be found here: https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/business/projects/fairoaks.htm

On abandoned vehicles:

- Vehicles in Sunnyvale must be moved every 72 hours. To report an abandoned vehicle, you can call the hotline anytime at 408-730-7150, email them at vehicleabatement@sunnyvale.ca.gov, or submit a report online here: https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/government/safety/services/abandoned.htm

On the Department of Public Safety (DPS):

- All offices in Sunnyvale DPS are cross-trained in police, firefighting, and EMT work
- In the mid-2000's, they had about 210 officers. Today they have only 202 positions

On sideshows:

- In the past, only people who were participating in the sideshow could be arrested or cited. A recent law has passed that allows people who are on the sidelines observing to now be cited or arrested
- If you see a sideshow in progress, call 911

On reporting crime:

- If there is a crime happening, call 911 first (even before posting about it on Nextdoor!)
- Be good witnesses. If it is safe to do so, capture video, write down the license plate, record the description of the vehicle (color, make, shape, bumper sticker,etc) and suspect (gender, clothing, tattoos, glasses, hair color, etc)
- If you have valuables (bikes, computers, etc), know the serial number for that item. If it gets stolen, call the non-emergency dispatch at 408-730-7180 right away, so the stolen item can be entered into their system

On supporting our community:

- Communication and visibility is key. Meet your neighbors!
- Join the neighborhood meetings (LVNA's are at 7:00pm on the second Wednesday of every month)

Other references:

- The app Nixel is a good way to follow DPS. They also have Twitter and Facebook
- Crimes are also reported on the Community Crime Map at https://communitycrimemap.com/?address=Sunnyvale,CA

- Special Memorial Day Photo Scavenger Hunt -

LVNA is hosting a fun scavenger hunt activity in the weeks leading up to Memorial Day. All ages are welcome and you can do it on your own over the course of two weeks!



LVNA has 20-40 American flags that will be placed throughout the neighborhood starting on Saturday May 14th and will stay up until Memorial Day (Monday May 30th). The first 10 people to find these flags, take a photo of each one, and contact board@lvnasv.org will win a $20 gift card. An announcement will be made when all gift cards have been claimed. If all gift cards have not been claimed by a certain time we will start posting hints for where the flags can be found.

Flags will be placed near the sidewalks, and will look like the flag in the photo on this page.

Additional announcements with final details of the scavenger hunt will be posted by Saturday May 14th on our website https://lvnasv.org and on our LVNA Nextdoor Group "LVNA (Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association)" - check back for details!

- Reminders -

Water Restrictions

With limited rain during this wet season, the drought continues into its third year. The period of January through March was the driest one on record for both Santa Clara County and California. Santa Clara County gets much of its water from the Sierra Nevada, and the annual snowpack measurement on April 1 recorded the fifth lowest amount of snowpack on record.

LVNA gets our water through the City of Sunnyvale's Public Works Department, and our water comes mostly from the Hetch Hetchy Reservoir in Yosemite National Park. The City is effectively the retailer to deliver the water to homes and businesses in our community. The City gets the water from Valley Water, the wholesale water and groundwater management agency that supplies water to much of Santa Clara County.

As a result of the continuing drought, on April 12, the Valley Water Board of Directors voted to include additional water restrictions. New water restrictions are:

1. Watering of lawns and ornamental landscapes in Santa Clara County is limited to no more than twice per week.
2. Watering during the warmest part of the day is prohibited. If you water, please water in the early morning or evening - it's better for the plants as well.

If you notice someone wasting water, you can either talk to them directly or you can report it through the Valley Water website here:
https://www.valleywater.org/droughtsaving-water/report-water-waste

Additional information can be found at these websites:

- https://valleywaternews.org/2022/04/19/valley-water-restricts-watering-in-santa-clara-county-to-no-more-than-two-days-a-week/
- https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/property/water/waterconservation.htm

Primary Election on June 7

California's primary election is coming up on June 7. All registered voters will receive their vote-by-mail ballot automatically. Ballots will be mailed on or before May 9, and drop boxes to return your vote-by-mail ballot will be open starting May 10. In-person voting is also available and polls will be open 7:00am to 7:00pm on Election Day. If you need another copy of the Official Voter Information Guide, please call (800) 345-VOTE (8683). This election will cover one congressional office and several state offices.

Congressional offices (two elections for one US Senate seat):

- US Senate special election to fill the vacancy left when Kamala Harris was elected as Vice President of the United States; the winner will serve until the term expires on January 3, 2023 (incumbent is Alex Padilla, who was appointed by Governor Newsom)
- US Senate regular election for a full six-year term for one senator that starts on January 3, 2023

Note that both US Senate elections are for one Senate seat. The special election is for who will hold that seat up until January 3, 2023, and the regular election is for who will hold that seat after January 3, 2023. California's other US Senate seat is currently held by Dianne Feinstein, whose term does not end until on January 2, 2025.

Statewide offices:

- Governor (incumbent is Gavin Newsom)
- Lieutenant Governor (incumbent is Eleni Kounalakis)
- Secretary of State (incumbent is Shirley N. Weber)
- Controller (incumbent is Betty Yee)
- Treasurer (incumbent is Fiona Ma)
- Attorney General (incumbent is Rob Bonta)
- Insurance Commissioner (incumbent is Ricardo Lara)
- Board of Equalization (one election each for Districts 1, 2, 3, and 4)
- Superintendent of Public Instruction (incumbent is Tony Thurmond)

LVNA CONTACTS

President	Lydia Fotiades	president@lvnasv.org
1st VP	Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org
Treasurer	Linh Ly	treasurer@lvnasv.org
Secretary	Brad Dux	secretary@lvnasv.org

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts & Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety - Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety - Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA Meeting Recap

LVNA Meeting on April 13th

April general meeting was not recorded, so we have included a more detailed recap / summary in this month's newsletter. Please see page 3.

Upcoming Events

May

11 — LVNA Monthly Meeting
Virtual - lvnasv.org/meeting

June

8 — LVNA Monthly Meeting
Virtual - lvnasv.org/meeting

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join.

To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap